order to provide better recommendations to its customers.
(B) Initially, each item on sale is in a different category (this would also work if we started from already pre-defined categories, like SSD disks or blenders, and grouped categories of objects selling together. But for the sake of simplicity, bear with me, and imagine there is only one product of each category on sale).
(C) Items frequently bought together, like laptops and external disks, or tennis rackets and tennis balls, are grouped together.
(D) After a while, things tend to stabilize and steady groups are formed. Now next time a customer adds a football to her cart, we can suggest a pair of skis as a follow up purchase.

Non-personalized recommendations, on the contrary, are not target on you, the customer, and are the same for all customers. They might be hardcoded associations, if you have no data at all, or based, for example, on purchases made by all other customers.

And that’s exactly what we are going to do: whenever customers add something to their cart, we would like to provide them with a recommendation about something else they might want to buy along. Our goal is finding products that are frequently bought together; sometimes we are going to find reasonable associations, like milk and bread bought together, some other times the result might be more surprising: you probably have already heard about the research performed at Walmart linking the purchase of